

COMMON CRIMES IN AVIATION, INSIDER THREATS AND THE RISK INDICATORS

1.0 INTRODUCTION

Aviation generally includes the activities surrounding mechanical flight and the aircraft industry. It has three (3) types as follows:

1. **COMMERCIAL AVIATION (CA)** which covers airlines' civil aviation operations that allows passengers/cargoes to travel/conveyed on a schedule. E.g. Air Peace, Cronos , Lufthansa, Qatar Airways, Allied Air, etc.
2. **GENERAL AVIATION (GA)** which are operations carried out by aircrafts other than commercial air transport, i.e. all civil aviation activities that are not commercial aviation which includes mostly private jets and helicopters. E.g. Executive Jets, Air Ambulance, Police Helicopters, NCS private jets, etc.
3. **MILITARY AVIATION** is the use of military aircraft and other flying machines for the purpose of conducting or enabling aerial warfare. E.g. NAF jets and bombardiers, etc.

2.0 COMMON CRIMES IN AVIATION

Most common crimes committed in aviation activities are but not limited to the following:

- a. Drug trafficking.
- b. Small and Light weapons or Firearms trafficking.
- c. Trafficking of persons and irregular migration.
- d. Trafficking of endangered species of Flora and Fauna.
- e. Trafficking of Minerals and other natural resources.
- f. Smuggling of other goods (e.g. taxable items, controlled/restricted items and prohibited items).
- g. Trafficking of cash/currencies.
- h. Escape by wanted persons.
- i. Terrorism

j. Smuggling of aircraft spare parts, etc.

Unfortunately, most if not all of the above-listed crimes are committed on a regular basis with the aid of insiders (i.e. employees working in aviation facilities). These employees are potentially known as Insider Threats.

3.0 INSIDER THREATS

Insider Threat is a term that refers to an individual with the intent to cause harm and with access and/or insider knowledge that would allow the individual to exploit vulnerabilities. In other words, an individual who has authorized access to and/or knowledge of an organisation's assets to use their access, either maliciously or unintentionally to act in a way that could negatively affect the organisation.

CLASSIFICATIONS OF INSIDER THREATS

1. Malicious: refers to those who intend to cause harm.
2. Non-malicious: are those who do not have that intention to cause harm.

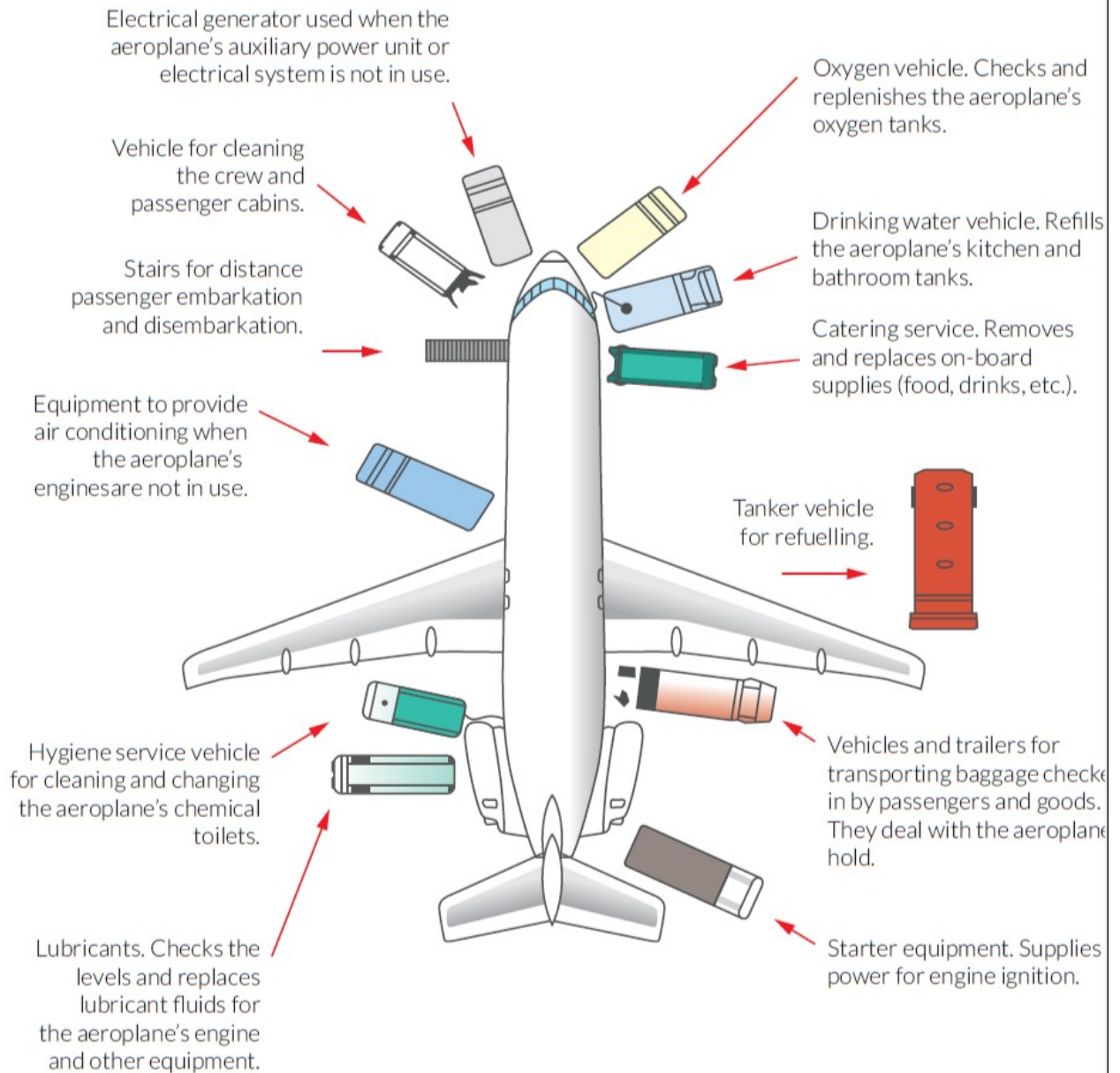
INSIDER WORKFORCES IN AVIATION ACTIVITIES

The following are the potential insider workforces that can constitute threats;

i. Ground Handling Personnels:

- ❖ Cargo handling agents (e.g. SAHCO, NAHCO)
- ❖ Ramp handling agents (e.g. NAHCO passenger services unit)
- ❖ Passenger handling agents
- ❖ Catering staff
- ❖ Aircraft Mechanics and Maintenance crews
- ❖ Airport suppliers
- ❖ Cleaning staff, etc.

Aeroplane maintenance on the ground or during a stop



ii. **Management and Administrative Personnels:** Airport officials, Airline operators, Customer services, etc. E.g. FAAN, NCAA, SERVICOM, Air Controllers and AVSEC officials.

iii. **Flight Crews**

iv. **Members of law enforcement agencies** e.g. NPF, NIS, DSS, NCS, NAF, NAQS, Port Health, etc

- v. Licenced and unlicenced clearing and forwarding agents.
- vi. Employees of shops, food and beverage outlets within the facility.
- vi. Private security personnels
- vi. Protocol officials, etc.

4.0 RISK INDICATORS

One of the ways of dealing with the phenomenon of insider threats is the early detection of potentially dangerous employees. It is therefore necessary to pay attention to a range of risk indicators that may alert us of the situation and help us to take the appropriate measures to minimize that risk. Risk indicators are also used for the selection of possible offenders in any Customs control that may be carried out.

The following list includes some of the main risk indicators:

A. Indicators related to Personality:

- History of mental health problems
- Problems due to lack of social skills
- History of offences or lack of respect for authority

B. Indicators related to Behaviour:

- Breaking of rules, including security rules
- Conflicts with co-workers or supervisors
- Unpunctuality or absenteeism
- Inexplicable change in physical appearance
- Activities and visits outside normal hours
- Sudden change in political or religious ideology, radicalisation
- Changes in usual behaviour (Anomalous behaviours like, nervousness, anxiety, isolation, aggressiveness/bursts of rage, substance abuse, etc.)
- Patterns of movement and communication

C. Organisational stressors:

- Demotion, suspension of duties or refusal of promotion

- Earnings below expectations
- Transfers to another post or location

D. Indicators related to services:

- Last minute changes to services
- Unusual delay in service rendering

E. Personal indicators associated with a lifestyle change:

- Financial problems
- Problems with partner, family or friends
- Legal problems
- Addiction problems
- Sudden changes in lifestyle/standard of living; in relation to the economy, whether negative or positive (i.e. increase in wealth)

5.0 CUSTOMS CONTROL MEASURES

In order to be able to mitigate the possible effects that an insider can cause within our areas of responsibilities, it is necessary to establish a range of effective control (risk mitigation) measures. A non-exhaustive list of possible measures to be implemented in this regard is included below:

1. Control of access to risk areas in aviation facilities, through:

- a. A pedestrian and vehicle access control system, especially on the airside of the facility, using technological and personal means to control who gains access, and when and in what circumstances they do so.
- b. Control measures at sensitive points: emergency doors, maintenance doors, access points enabled, baggage reclaim belts, etc.

2. Implementation of organisational policies and procedures which limit the opportunities that insiders have to act, such as the following:

- Mandatory continuous identification of airport personnel when in restricted areas.
- Strict access control, including on the issuing of access credentials.
- Clear dismissal/suspension policies in cases of failure to comply with rules.
- Task separation so that no one can work alone.
- Control of access privileges, restricted to each individual's area of work.
- Unpredictability in establishing controls.

3. Training and awareness-raising programme for airport employees on this type of threat and on the consequences that may arise for the labour force as a whole, explaining:

- The insider threat phenomenon and the importance of employee participation in the mitigation of this risk.
- Behaviour indicators; raising employee awareness so that they are alert to any abnormal situation.
- The importance of reporting any suspicious activity early.

THANK YOU